

KF Reading Guide

Chapter 9: *The Self-Effacing Solution*¹

1. What is the second major solution for inner conflicts? (214.1)
2. This solution represents a move in what direction? (214.1)
3. What do expansive types glorify and cultivate in themselves? (214.2)
4. How do mastery types tend to relate to others? (214.2)
5. What is abhorrent to mastery types? (214.2)
6. What must self-effacing people not feel? (215.3)
7. What does the self-effacing type cultivate and unwittingly exaggerate? (215.3)
8. What do self-effacing people long for? (215.3)
9. The self-effacing person lives with what diffuse sense? (215.4)
10. What does the diffuse sense of failure tend to make self-effacing people feel? (215.4)
11. How do self-effacing people externalize their self-hate and self-contempt? (215.4)
12. How have self-effacing people solved their inner conflict? (216.1)

13. How does this type feel about any wish, striving, or reaching out for more? (218.1)
14. For the self-effacing type, “selfishness” includes what? (218.2)
15. Which of these self-effacing characteristics do you recognize in yourself or others? (217.4–219.4)
16. When is the only time that this type can express hostility? (219.2)
17. Why are self-effacing people poor fighters? (219.2)
18. The taboos and self-minimizing of the self-effacing type constitute what process? (219.3)
19. What fear is specifically indicative of self-effacing trends? (220.1)
20. While curtailed in any pursuit on their own behalf, what are self-effacing people free to do and, according to their inner dictates, what should they be? (220.2)
21. What two shoulds are closely intertwined in the self-effacing mind? (220.2)
22. How do self-effacing types feel about aggressive, arrogant, or vindictive traits in others? (220.3)
23. What plays a great part in the morbid dependency of this type? (220.3–221.1)

24. As self-effacing people become strong enough to face their conflict, what puts them under a constant crossfire? (221.2)
25. How do self-effacing types solve their early conflicts with people? (221.5)
26. To gain affection of a kind, what price does this child pay? (222.1)
27. What may the self-effacing type experience during adolescence? (222.1)
28. What characteristics of the self-effacing child's early environment strike you? (222.1)
29. The idealized image of a self-effacing person is primarily a composite of what qualities? (222.2)
30. What begins the shrinking process that leaves the self-effacing person feeling small and helpless? (223.1)
31. The weakness of the self-effacing solution lies in what two factors? (223.2)
- A.
 - B.
32. Why does self-hate seem more vicious in this type than in other kinds of neurosis? (224.3)

33. Why can't self-effacing people stave off self-accusation, accuse others, or express any kind of hostility? (224.4–225.1)
34. How does this type behave toward people when feeling attacked? (225.2)
35. How do self-effacing people show passive externalization? (225.3)
36. Self-effacing people feel profoundly insecure, so what old pattern must they follow to strengthen their inner position? (226.1)
37. What makes it impossible for the self-effacing type to be discriminating? (226.2)
38. What does this type persistently and unrealistically expect from others? (227.1)
39. What do the great emotional needs of self-effacing people override? (227.1)
40. Does this type have a real faith in mankind? (227.1)
41. What needs of the self-effacing person are described here? (227.2–228.2)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
 - D.
 - E.

42. What does this type's need for help amount to? (228.2)
43. What is an intrinsic part of the self-effacing solution? (228.2)
44. Upon what do self-effacing people base their claims? (229.2)
45. Why does suffering affect this type in a much deeper way? (229.3)
46. What is a more unconscious and more destructive basis for self-effacing claims? (229.4–230.1)
47. In a few words, how would the author describe the self-effacing type? (230.2)
48. In what other situation does this type feel abused? (230.3)
49. What is the more poignant source of abuse that self-effacing people suffer? (230.4)
50. Why do self-effacing people need to defend their victim role? (231.1)
51. Why might these people provoke others to treat them badly? (231.2)
52. What is the greatest stumbling block to seeing and experiencing the inner conflict for which self-effacement is a solution? (232.1)
53. Against whom do self-effacing types turn when they feel resentment? (232.2)

54. What is this type's most characteristic way of expressing vindictive resentment? (232.3)
55. What other function does suffering acquire for this type? (233.1)
56. What kind of environment is favorable for self-effacing neurotics? (233.3)
57. For the self-effacing type, what are some of the functions of neurotic suffering? (234.3–235.4)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
 - D.
 - E.
 - F.
58. Suffering per se appears as the proof of what? (236.3)
59. What must take place before this type can dispense with all the functions of neurotic suffering? (236.4–237.1)
60. Self-effacing people may arouse resentment, but what do they really need? (238.2)

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.